

ment to the Gurgaon police that Kumar's house in Sector 23, which had been sealed by the Delhi Police in December 2000, was broken into and used for carrying out illegal transplants. The doctor's accomplice Upendra Aggarwal has blurted out the names of Haryana politicians Kumar had links with. One of them had inaugurated the Gurgaon hospital on January 26, 1997. Yet another had reportedly bailed him out when Income Tax sleuths raided his premises in 2000. Off the record, officials admit that despite meticulous efforts to book Kumar, many in the police department allegedly defended him in return for a hefty compensation. Nabbing the kidney trader was difficult as he operated under several false identities and procured fake pass-

ports. "We have identified several vips and bureaucrats named by Upendra," says Manzil Saini, ASP, Moradabad, who led the Gurgaon raid.

How and when Kumar got into the business isn't clear. Parts of the police's account do not match what others say. While his partners in crime confessed to the police that he carried out most of the surgeries, his absconding brother's wife claims that he was only a graduate of ayurvedic medicine from Radhakisan Toshniwal Ayurvedic Mahavidyalaya near Nagpur in Maharashtra. According to Bollywood sources (who refuse to be identified), his dream was to be a film star

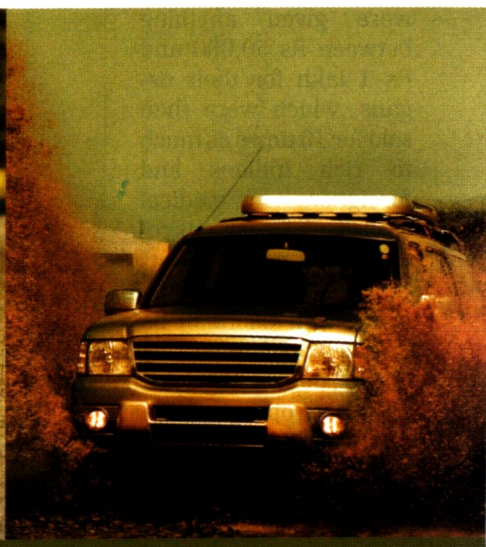
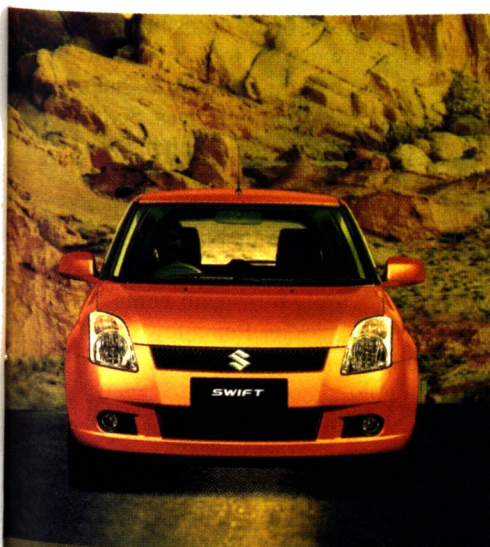
and he started work as a spot-boy and light-boy. Others say that he worked as a ward boy at Mumbai's Breach Candy Hospital, where he sensed business opportunity in the numerous cases of foreign patients coming to India for kidneys. He became a 'doctor' after establishing a small clinic in Khar, and then the Ayurvedic Kaushalya Nursing Home in the same area.

He may have amassed hundreds of crores, but Kumar's personal life was never rosy. The son of a respected and idealistic freedom fighter from Patur-Nandapur in Akola, Maharashtra, Kumar wasn't a keen student. His foray into crime shamed his parents and his wife into leaving the village and severing all ties with him. Ever since, dating and matrimony have been as serialised in Kumar's life as his transplants.



"He is a serial offender who won't give up. It will be years before he is convicted."

RAKESH MARIA, JOINT COMMISSIONER, CRIME, MUMBAI



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